AI Write Up

1. We did not use AI for ideation purposes or to refine our ideas in phase 3.

2. How we used AI to write the code:

We used AI for an initial prototype of this phase where we took two of our code files and asked Claude (Sonnet 5.5 *medium*) to combine them while preserving the certain features that we wanted to keep. This was a very easy way to get the ball rolling on creating our final version while creating a tangible mockup to decide whether or not we liked a certain idea. It was definitely not intended to be the final version and provided a good jumping off point for us to keep ideating and experimenting.

3. Overall Bakeoff 2 AI Reflection

Would you be ok with these reflections being shared (anonymously) in class?

We don't mind our musings being shared anonymously with the class.

What was AI useful for? What was it less useful for?

It's nice for speed and getting the first ideas out of the way. It's also really nice for creating interactive low-fidelity prototypes, allowing you to test and experiment with your ideas early. As long as you're specific about what exactly it is you want, LLMs are decently good at generating code quickly, and even better if you have a jumping off point (like template code or previous prototypes). It was definitely not creative when it came to ideation though. The ideas it came up with for each of us independently were often very similar if not exactly the same.

How might you incorporate AI into your design workflow for the future?

We don't think we'd ever use it for ideation or creative purposes because at the end of the day everything it "thinks of" was already thought of first which is how it knew to give it to us because of positive reinforcement as it was trained. Generative AI at the end of the day is a really fancy text-prediction algorithm, which is great for repetitive routine things like code where there are established patterns, but not so good for thinking outside the box because it literally can't.